Michael Hutchinson

Staff Engineer, Manchester, UK

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Skills

Languages & Frameworks: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), React, Node.js, Next.js, GraphQL

UI & Styling: Shadcn/ui, TailwindCSS, Styled Components, Storybook

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Observability

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB, Prisma

Testing: Playwright, Cypress, Jest, React Testing Library

AI & Tooling: Claude Code, MCP, AI Agents, Prompt Engineering

Leadership: Technical Strategy, Architecture, Line Management, Mentoring, RFCs

Social

github.com/michael-hutchinson

linkedin.com/in/mhutchinson4

www.michaelhutchinson.me

www.ukrunner.com

References

Available on request

About

Staff Engineer with 10+ years building and scaling web platforms used by millions. Currently at Thrive an AI-powered learning platform serving 5M+ users across 60+ countries for organisations including Vodafone, British Airways, Aston Martin, and Google. I operate across the full stack, from hands-on TypeScript/React/Node.js development to architectural decisions, line management, and engineering culture. My current focus is integrating AI into every stage of the development lifecycle from code generation, code reviews, testing, and deployment and building the tooling and culture for AI-first engineering teams.

Experience

Thrive Learning Limited

Staff Engineer | Feb 2026 – Present

- Championing AI integration into development workflows including code generation, automated review, and testing
- Providing technical direction and architectural oversight for a platform serving 5M+ users across 60+ countries
- Line managing and mentoring engineers across multiple squads
- Defining and driving engineering standards, RFCs, and technical roadmaps

Lead Frontend Engineer | April 2024 – February 2026

- Led a full UX overhaul and design system migration to Shadcn/ui - 100+ components, WCAG accessibility compliance, and RTL support for Arabic-speaking markets
- Architected and executed the decomposition of a monolithic frontend into domain-driven micro frontends, improving team autonomy and deployment independence
- Built a social learning feature now available to all 500+ enterprise customers including Google and Emirates
- Migrated from Bitbucket to GitHub and rebuilt CI/CD pipelines in GitHub Actions, cutting build times from 20 minutes to 8 minutes (60% reduction)

Senior Frontend Developer | March 2022 – April 2024

- Developed and shipped features on a React/TypeScript platform serving 5M+ users at enterprise scale
- Contributed to architectural decisions and frontend standards across the engineering org
- Mentored junior and mid-level developers through code review and pairing

Cheshire Data systems Limited

Senior Web Developer | April 2021 – February 2022

- Technical leader in a squad delivering insurance platforms for Tesco Bank, Sainsbury's, and RAC at one of the UK's largest insurance tech companies (~65% of UK price comparison insurance sites)
- Drove technical direction, architecture decisions, and code quality standards within the squad
- Contributed to CDL's on-premises to AWS cloud migration

Web Developer | December 2019 – April 2021

- Built and maintained customer-facing insurance quoting and policy management interfaces
- Progressed from mid-level to senior responsibilities within 18 months

Boohoo Limited

UX Executive | July 2019 – December 2019

- Designed and developed A/B tests targeting conversion rate, basket value, and sales uplift at one of the UK's largest online fashion retailers (£1B+ revenue)
- Owned the full cycle: hypothesis → design → development → analysis → implementation
- Bridged design and engineering, reducing handoff friction and accelerating test velocity

Education

2012 - 2016	Leeds Beckett University	**BSc Hons Computer Science**
2016 - 2017		**MSc Information & Technology**